FIRST: IS IT REALLY PHRAGMITES?

A photograph-first guide to the giant reeds you might find along creeks, ponds and trails.

GIANT REED

Arundo donax



WHOLE PLANT / HABIT

- Thick, cane-like stems
- Long, broad, drooping leaves
- **Leaf base flares around stem**



CHECK THE CLASPING LEAF BASE

Photo 2: zoom in on the next useful clue.

INTRODUCED

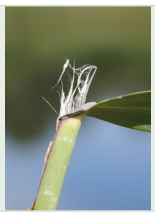
COMMON REED

Phragmites australis



WHOLE PLANT / HABIT

- Tall stems with leafy sheaths
- Usually a soft, feathery plume
- **Fringed ligule at leaf collar**



IF THIS FITS: CONTINUE TO LINEAGE ID

Photo 2: zoom in on the next useful clue.

LINEAGE UNKNOWN

GIANT CUTGRASS

Zizaniopsis miliacea



WHOLE PLANT / HABIT

- Very large, coarse wetland grass
- Loose, widely branching head
- **Long inner ligule (6-20 mm)**



CHECK THE OPEN PANICLE + TRUE LIGULE

Photo 2: zoom in on the next useful clue.

NATIVE REGIONALLY

FIELD ROUTE 1 **STEP BACK** > 2 **CHECK THE LEAF BASE** > 3 **PHOTO THE FLOWERING HEAD**

A fluffy plume alone cannot tell you whether a Phragmites stand is native or invasive.

NEXT PAGE: CONFIRM PHRAGMITES, THEN CHECK NATIVE / INTRODUCED / GULF COAST.

Photos: source-linked CC/public-domain specimens; not Hays County vouchers. Layout and cropping for study.

For review - approve before Page 02